



Muncie Sanitary District September 2, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=rOJWtmxouaU
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Target Category	muncie_city

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Board of Sanitary Commissioners Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: September 2, 2026

Body: Board of Sanitary Commissioners

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order at [00:00:05](#) by the presiding officer for the September 2, 2026 Board of Sanitary Commissioners meeting.
- **Attendance:** All commissioners were present at the start of the meeting.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance [00:00:09](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** The Board considered the minutes from the August 19, 2026 meeting [00:08:36](#). A motion to approve was made and seconded, passing with 4 "Aye" votes and 1 abstention (Mr. Smith abstained due to his absence at the prior meeting) [00:08:45](#).
- **Register of Claims:** The Board considered the register of claims totaling \$814,398.48 [00:08:59](#). Following a motion and second, the claims were **Approved by Voice Vote** [00:09:20](#).

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:18:50 Resolution 2026-05: Ordinance Amending Personnel Policies Handbook**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Rick Conrad, District Administrator.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Administrator Conrad explained that the amendment permits the district board to place employees on paid administrative leave **00:19:02**. This option covers administrative, investigatory, safety, disciplinary, or other operational reasons, and serves as a standard operational tool for unforeseen circumstances requiring an employee's temporary absence while remaining paid **00:19:06**.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote **00:20:22**.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:00:50 Judy Kerry:** Speaking on behalf of Trinity United Methodist Church (1210 South Hackley Street), Ms. Kerry addressed an unexpected water main break that occurred in an old church building (built in 1951) **00:01:06**. While the water company established a repayment plan, she expressed concern that the Muny Sanitation District has not offered a payment plan and continues to assess \$30 monthly penalties, preventing the 7-member senior congregation from paying down their elevated sanitation bills (\$479.70 initial bill) **00:03:22**.
 - *Note:* The presiding officer noted that the district generally does not comment from the dais, but invited her to speak with the district administrator after the meeting to sort out a solution **00:06:40**.
 - **00:07:05 Rick Yer (Newsman):** Addressed the recent disaster and flooding from a couple of weeks prior, expressing gladness that the district is cleaning up and assisting displaced residents **00:07:07**. He cautioned the board against purchasing property solely to bypass draining parts of South Muncie, raising concerns about borrowing money for separating storm and sanitary sewers if it increases customer utility rates **00:07:15**. He also commented on city-county treatment cost disputes, hoping sanitary districts avoid raising bills over the disagreement **00:07:59**.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **District Administrator Update (00:09:42):** Rick Conrad thanked department heads for hosting an employee appreciation event and congratulated the Bureau of Water Quality for winning the Indiana Water Environment Association's Laboratory Excellence Award for 2026 alongside muscle propagation presentations **00:10:18**.

He noted the sanitation department is currently without a superintendent but expects it resolved by the week's end 00:10:43.

- **Flood Summary Report:** Administrator Conrad provided an after-action summary regarding the historic flood from three weeks prior (following 10 inches of rain) 00:10:59. He highlighted that the 6-mile Muncie levee system and the new \$6 million east-side tieback levee held successfully with no breaches, protecting approximately 7,000 people and \$3 billion in property 00:11:27. Challenges primarily involved overwhelmed drainage systems on the south side (Vine, Perching, Elm, Manville, and Drum Edition) due to intense rainfall rates and high river/creek elevations blocking discharge 00:13:41. The district continues cleanup efforts through rolloff dumpsters, expanded curbside collection, and free disposal at ECR 00:13:15.
- **White River Cleanup:** Mr. Clark announced that the annual White River Cleanup is scheduled for September 19 at 8:00 a.m., with volunteer sign-ups available at beautifulmuncie.org 00:20:39.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was concluded with a motion to adjourn, which was **Approved by Voice Vote** 00:22:42.